Subsequently, the regime crushed any signs of dissent. The use of photographic and video footage to identify protesters was especially effective. Thousands of civilians (many not involved whatsoever in the uprising) were detained, questioned, and in many cases tortured. On the surface, the regime seemed to have suppressed the movement, but the underlying current remained. The brutality in which the sangha was treated and the unbelievable destruction of monasteries guaranteed that intense resentment remained.

The image of the army probably hit an all-time low following the Saffron Revolution. Throughout the history of Myanmar, governments have always sought legitimacy through the sangha and the level of violence used against the monks has damaged the relationship permanently.

The international community responded with near-universal condemnation of the Myanmar authorities. Even Asian nations that usually are more muted in condemning the regime spoke out in protest. Singapore (speaking on behalf of the entire ASEAN body) expressed revulsion over the violence against the monks. Even China, the main ally of the regime, issued a statement calling for a peaceful resolution to the crisis. Finally, the United Nations Security Council issued a presidential statement deploring the violence against peaceful protesters. The UN Human Rights Council called for the release of political prisoners and national reconciliation among the parties.

As far as specific tangible actions to be taken, the international community differs. Several Western powers, including the United States and Canada, pushed for new sanctions to try and force policy change by the SPDC. Most of Asian countries, including all of Myanmar's neighbors, oppose such punitive action. The rationale behind not taking action is that it would undermine diplomatic efforts and diminish international influence overall. The middle path is taken by the EU and Japan, which want a more carrot-and-stick approach with targeted sanctions in combination with incentives to reform. The overall lack of international resolve regarding tangible action weakens the ability of global powers to influence outcomes.

The implications of the Saffron Revolution are considerable. Internationally, the regime's brutality was once again on public display. Condemnation was widespread as the protest crackdown was front-page